

Project Design Phase

Problem – Solution Fit Template

Date	18 June 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	ShopEZ
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Problem – Solution Fit Template:

The Problem-Solution Fit simply means that you have found a problem with your customer and that the solution you have realized for it actually solves the customer's problem. It helps entrepreneurs, marketers and corporate innovators identify behavioral patterns and recognize what would work and why

Purpose:

- ☐ Solve complex problems in a way that fits the state of your customers.
- ☐ Succeed faster and increase your solution adoption by tapping into existing mediums and channels of behavior.
- ☐ Sharpen your communication and marketing strategy with the right triggers and messaging.
- ☐ Increase touch-points with your company by finding the right problem-behavior fit and building trust by solving frequent annoyances, or urgent or costly problems.
- ☐ **Understand the existing situation in order to improve it for your target group.**

Template:

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) Who is your customer? I.e. working parents of 0-5 y.o. kids	6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS What constraints prevent your customers from taking action or limit their choices of solutions? I.e. spending power, budget, no cash, network connection, available devices.	5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS Which solutions are available to the customers when they face the problem or need to get the job done? What have they tried in the past? What pros & cons do these solutions have? I.e. pen and paper is an alternative to digital notetaking
Define CS, fit into CC		Explore AS, differentiate
2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS Which jobs-to-be-done (or problems) do you address for your customers? There could be more than one; explore different sides.	9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE What is the real reason that this problem exists? What is the back story behind the need to do this job? I.e. customers have to do it because of the change in regulations.	7. BEHAVIOUR What does your customer do to address the problem and get the job done? I.e. directly related: find the right solar panel installer, calculate usage and benefits; Indirectly associated: customers spend free time on volunteering work (I.e. Greenpeace)
Focus on J&P, tap into BE, understand RC		Focus on J&P, tap into BE, understand RC
3. TRIGGERS What triggers customers to act? I.e. seeing their neighbour installing solar panels, reading about a more efficient solution in the news.	10. YOUR SOLUTION If you are working on an existing business, write down your current solution first, fill in the canvas, and check how much it fits reality. If you are working on a new business proposition, then keep it blank until you fill in the canvas and come up with a solution that fits within customer limitations, solves a problem and matches customer behaviour.	8. CHANNELS of BEHAVIOUR 8.1 ONLINE What kind of actions do customers take online? Extract online channels from #7 8.2 OFFLINE What kind of actions do customers take offline? Extract offline channels from #7 and use them for customer development.
Identify strong TR & EM		Extract online & offline CH of BE
4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER How do customers feel when they face a problem or a job and afterwards? I.e. lost, insecure > confident, in control - use it in your communication strategy & design.		
Identify strong TR & EM		

References:

- <https://www.ideahackers.network/problem-solution-fit-canvas/>
- <https://medium.com/@epicantus/problem-solution-fit-canvas-aa3dd59cb4fe>

1. Customer Segment(s) Busy, tech-conscious online consumers who value speed and minimal friction, alongside small-to-medium enterprise (SME) retail owners who need a streamlined, easy-to-manage digital storefront without the overhead of complex legacy systems.

2. Jobs-to-be-Done / Problems Customers need to quickly browse, select, and purchase various categorized goods (fashion, electronics, decor) without losing their shopping cart data across sessions. Admins need to effortlessly manage inventory, track real-time sales metrics, and generate clean physical receipts for accounting or reimbursements.

3. Triggers Users are prompted to look for a better solution after experiencing cart abandonment due to an unexpected session timeout on a traditional site, or when a customer immediately demands a clean, professional printed invoice that traditional platforms cannot easily generate without premium plugins.

4. Emotions: Before / After

- **Before:** Frustrated by slow load times, overwhelmed by cluttered interfaces requiring redundant inputs (e.g., selecting sizes for electronics), and anxious about losing cart selections.
- **After:** Confident and in control due to a persistent shopping state, relieved by a rapid under-two-minute checkout, and highly satisfied with the seamless, adaptive UI.

5. Available Solutions Current alternatives include large, feature-dense platforms (like Amazon or Magento) that are cluttered with third-party ads and complicated promotional matrices, or basic static e-commerce pages that are fast but entirely lack personalized features, persistent shopping states, or real-time admin syncing.

6. Customer Constraints Strict time limitations dictate that users typically shop during short breaks, requiring immediate responsiveness. Hardware constraints mean they frequently shop on mobile devices over cellular networks, necessitating a lightweight page footprint. Additionally, they have a low "cognitive budget" and will not tolerate filling out complex or irrelevant forms.

7. Behaviour Users exhibit a low tolerance for friction; they will immediately abandon their carts if the checkout process takes longer than two minutes or if they are forced to navigate irrelevant dropdowns. They

gravitate toward minimalist apps and advocate for clean, direct-to-consumer digital experiences.

8. Channels of Behaviour

- **Online:** Tech-focused communities (Reddit, ProductHunt), design forums, and social media shopping links (Instagram, Facebook).
- **Offline:** Co-working spaces, university campuses, cafes, and local brick-and-mortar retail shops.

9. Problem Root Cause Most legacy e-commerce architectures rely on rigid, one-size-fits-all database templates that fail to dynamically adjust the UI to different product categories. Furthermore, they lack modern client-side state synchronization, leading to dropped sessions and lost cart data when users navigate away or refresh.

10. Your Solution ShopEZ is a high-performance MERN stack application featuring an adaptive storefront that dynamically alters its layout based on context (e.g., hiding sizing grids for non-apparel items). It ensures cart persistence using local cache mechanisms synced to React Context, and provides admins with a specialized @media print layout for instant, high-fidelity physical invoice generation.